PRACTICE EXAM 07 / EXAM SET 01

Domain 7: Medical Law and Ethics

7 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Privacy Confidentiality and Information Release

SCENARIO An older adult's daughter requests a copy of the patient's office records. She presents an advance directive naming her as health care agent only when specified conditions are met. The office has not verified whether her authority is currently effective. The patient is not present, and no other authorization or disclosure basis has been established. Clinic policy routes uncertain representative authority to the privacy officer for verification under applicable law.

How should the medical assistant handle this request?

A. Release the records after confirming that the daughter's name appears in the directive.

B. Release the records after confirming that the daughter is listed as the emergency contact.

C. Reject the request because an agent cannot exercise a patient's record-access rights.

D. Refer the document for verification of the daughter's current authority before releasing records.

Q02 | Consent Patient Rights and Directives

SCENARIO An adult with decision-making capacity arrives for a routine blood draw. Before venipuncture, the patient withdraws their arm and says, "I do not want this test today." The order remains active, and no emergency exists. Clinic policy requires staff to document a refusal and inform the ordering provider.

Which response appropriately respects the patient's decision?

A. Explain that the active order requires completion of the blood draw today.

B. Stop preparation, acknowledge the refusal, and document and report it according to policy.

C. Ask the accompanying spouse to authorize the blood draw in the patient's place.

D. Offer to collect a smaller sample and continue unless the patient objects again.

Q03 | Scope Ethics and Mandatory Reporting

SCENARIO A medical assistant discovers a transposed blood pressure value in their authenticated electronic entry. The correct value is available on the original measurement record. A supervisor says, "Delete the old entry so the mistake will not show." Clinic policy requires corrections to preserve the original entry and identify the correction's author, date, time, and reason; the assistant is authorized to correct their own entries through this process.

Which action best protects record integrity?

A. Use the correction process to enter the verified value and preserve the original entry and audit trail.
B. Delete the original entry and reenter the verified value using the original date and time.
C. Leave the incorrect value unchanged and place the verified value in a private reminder file.
D. Replace the value under the supervisor's login because the supervisor requested the change.

Q04 | Consent Patient Rights and Directives

SCENARIO A patient has signed the consent form for an office skin biopsy. Before the procedure begins, the patient asks the medical assistant, "Could this leave a scar, and are there other options? I signed because I thought I had to." The physician who will perform the procedure is available. Clinic policy assigns the procedure-specific discussion of risks, benefits, and alternatives to that physician.

What should the medical assistant do?

A. Show the patient the signature and explain that the consent discussion is complete.
B. Read the standard handout and proceed if the patient does not ask another question.
C. Explain the biopsy's individual risks and select an alternative for the patient to consider.
D. Pause preparation and ask the physician to address the questions and confirm the patient's voluntary decision.

Q05 | Scope Ethics and Mandatory Reporting

SCENARIO At a Florida pediatric office, an 8-year-old tells the medical assistant, "My dad hit me with his belt last night." The assistant sees linear bruises on the child's upper arm. The applicable Florida reporting rule requires a person who knows or has reasonable cause to suspect child abuse by a parent or caregiver to report immediately to the central abuse hotline. Clinic procedure also calls for notifying the provider and recording objective observations without delaying the required report.

Which action fulfills the assistant's responsibility?

A. Immediately report the suspicion to the hotline, notify the provider, and document observations and the child's statement.
B. Notify the provider and wait for the provider to confirm abuse before contacting the hotline.
C. Ask the father to explain the bruises and report only if he admits causing them.
D. Schedule a follow-up examination and report if additional bruises appear at that visit.

Q06 | Privacy Confidentiality and Information Release

SCENARIO A medical assistant notices a neighbor's name on the appointment schedule but has no assigned role in that visit. A coworker suggests opening the neighbor's chart to confirm a rumor about substance use and says patients with that history should receive less attention. Clinic policy permits record access only for assigned work and requires equitable care and reporting of suspected privacy or conduct violations.

Which response best applies confidentiality and professional ethics?

A. Open the chart to determine whether the rumor justifies changing the patient's care.
B. Decline the chart access and address the inappropriate request and bias through the designated supervisor.
C. Ask a staff member assigned to the visit to check the rumor and share only the diagnosis.
D. Avoid opening the chart but recommend moving the patient's appointment to a less busy day.

Q07 | Scope Ethics and Mandatory Reporting

SCENARIO A patient calls a primary care office with questions about home blood pressure readings and asks whether to take an extra antihypertensive tablet. The medical assistant can collect information and relay clinician instructions but is not authorized to select medication doses. There is no patient-specific dose-adjustment order or standing protocol. Clinic policy requires medication-adjustment questions to be routed promptly to a licensed clinician.

Which action remains within the assistant's authorized role?

A. Recommend an extra tablet if the reported reading is higher than the last office reading.
B. Recommend withholding the next dose until the patient can attend a follow-up appointment.
C. Record the readings, symptoms, and request, and route them promptly to the clinician without choosing a dose.
D. Tell the patient to use a family member's dose-adjustment instructions until the clinician responds.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 D	02 B	03 A	04 D	05 A	06 B
07 C					

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: D

Refer the document for verification of the daughter's current authority before releasing records.

A health care agent's authority and its effective conditions must be verified under applicable law before relying on that authority for this request. The document's existence does not establish that its activation conditions are satisfied, and emergency-contact status does not itself establish representative authority. An authorized personal representative may exercise applicable record-access rights within the scope of that authority.

Q02 | Correct answer: B

Stop preparation, acknowledge the refusal, and document and report it according to policy.

A patient with decision-making capacity may refuse a recommended procedure, including after an order has been placed. The assistant should stop, document the refusal objectively, and notify the provider so questions or concerns can be addressed. Neither the active order nor the spouse's preference overrides this patient's refusal.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

Use the correction process to enter the verified value and preserve the original entry and audit trail.

The authorized correction process makes the record accurate while preserving the history of the change. Concealing an authenticated entry or using another person's login compromises accountability and violates the stated policy. A supervisor's instruction does not justify hiding an error; pressure to bypass the process should be escalated through the clinic's designated channel.

Q04 | Correct answer: D

Pause preparation and ask the physician to address the questions and confirm the patient's voluntary decision.

Informed consent involves understanding and a voluntary choice, not merely a signature. The physician must address this patient's procedure-specific questions and concerns about feeling pressured before proceeding. The assistant supports the process by pausing preparation and obtaining that discussion rather than substituting an independent risk-and-treatment explanation.

Q05 | Correct answer: A

Immediately report the suspicion to the hotline, notify the provider, and document observations and the child's statement.

The child's statement and the observed bruises support reasonable suspicion under the reporting rule provided. The assistant must report immediately rather than investigate, obtain an admission, or wait for proof. Provider notification and objective documentation support care and accountability but do not replace or delay the required report.

Q06 | Correct answer: B

Decline the chart access and address the inappropriate request and bias through the designated supervisor.

Curiosity and neighborhood familiarity do not create a work-related need to access protected information. The proposed access violates the stated privacy policy, and the suggestion to reduce attention based on a stigmatized history raises a separate ethical concern about equitable care. The assistant should use the designated reporting channel without opening the record or spreading the rumor.

Q07 | Correct answer: C

Record the readings, symptoms, and request, and route them promptly to the clinician without choosing a dose.

Collecting information and promptly relaying the request are within the assistant's stated role. Selecting an extra dose or advising a medication hold would create a treatment decision without an authorized order or protocol. Another patient's instructions do not authorize a dose change for this patient.

End of Practice Exam